



BITS Pilani

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MGTS F211

PRINCIPLES OF MANAGEMENT

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Managing Communication

Learning Outcomes



1. Define the nature and function of communication.
2. Compare and contrast methods of interpersonal communication.
3. Identify barriers to effective interpersonal communication and how to overcome them.
 - i. Develop your skill at listening actively.
 - ii. Know how to identify the differences in how genders communicate.
4. Explain how communication can flow most effectively in organizations.
5. Describe how technology affects managerial communication and organizations.
6. Discuss contemporary issues in communication.

What Is Communication?

Communication is the transfer and understanding of meaning.

- Transfer means the message was received in a form that can be interpreted by the receiver.
- Understanding the message is not the same as the receiver agreeing with the message



What Is Communication? (cont.)

- **Interpersonal Communication** – communication between two or more people.
- **Organizational Communication** – all the patterns, networks, and systems of communications within an organization.

Functions of Communication

- **Control**
 - Formal and informal communications act to control individuals' behaviors in organizations.
- **Motivation**
 - Communications clarify for employees what is to be done, how well they have done it, and what can be done to improve performance.



Functions of Communication (cont.)

- **Emotional Expression**
 - Social interaction in the form of work group communications provides a way for employees to express themselves.
- **Information**
 - Individuals and work groups need information to make decisions or to do their work.



Methods of Interpersonal Communication

- **Message** – a purpose to be conveyed.
 - **Encoding** – converting a message into symbols.
 - **Channel** – the medium a message travels along.
 - **Decoding** – retranslating a sender's message.

Methods of Interpersonal Communication (cont.)

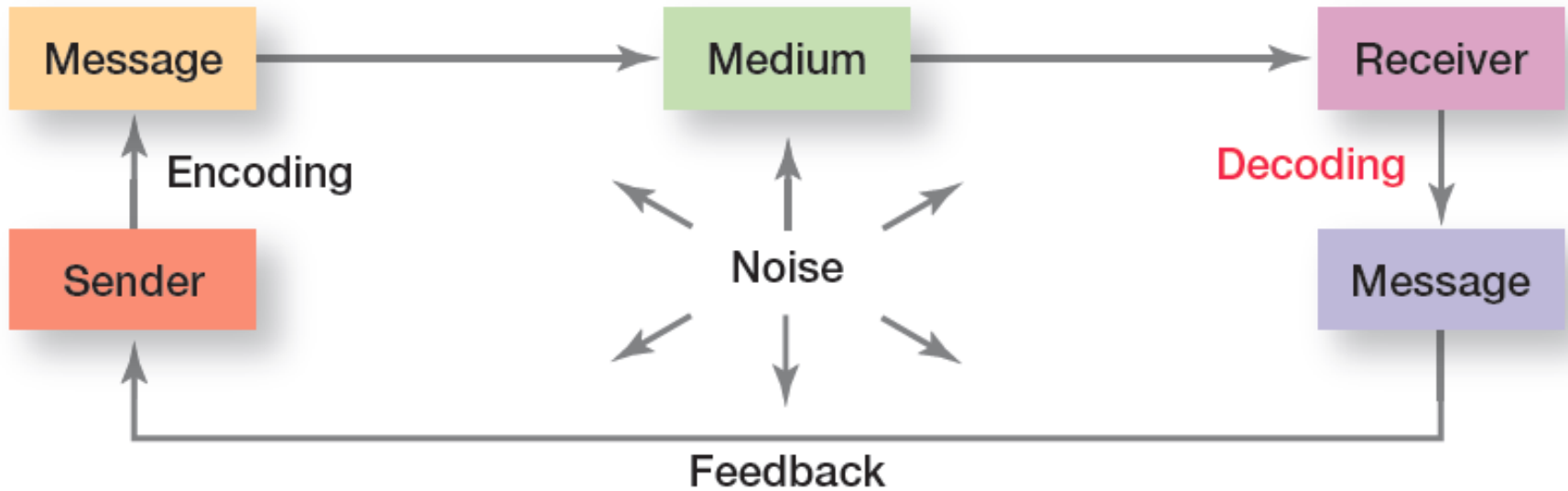


Communication process – the seven elements involved in transferring meaning from one person to another.

- **Noise** – any disturbances that interfere with the transmission, receipt, or feedback of a message.

Exhibit 14-1

The Interpersonal Communication Process



Nonverbal Communication

- **Nonverbal communication** – communication transmitted without words.
 - **Body language** – gestures, facial configurations, and other body movements that convey meaning.
 - **Verbal intonation** – an emphasis given to words or phrases that conveys meaning.

Exhibit 14-2

Comparison of Communication Methods

<i>High Feedback Potential</i>	<i>Low Feedback Potential</i>
- Face-to-face - Telephone - Computer conference	Publications
<i>High Complexity Capacity</i>	<i>Low Complexity Capacity</i>
Face-to-face	Bulletin boards
<i>High Breadth Potential</i>	<i>Low Breadth Potential</i>
- Face-to-face - Bulletin boards - E-mail	- Postal mail - Audio-videotapes
<i>High Confidentiality</i>	<i>Low Confidentiality</i>
- Face-to-face - Voice mail	- Publications - Bulletin boards - Audio-videotapes - Teleconference

Exhibit 14-2

Comparison of Communication Methods (cont.)

<i>High Encoding Ease</i> - Face-to-face - Telephone	<i>Low Encoding Ease</i> Publications
<i>High Time-Decoding Ease</i> - Face-to-face - Telephone - Hotlines - Voice mail	<i>Low Time-Decoding Ease</i> - Memos - Postal mail - Fax - Publications
<i>High Space Constraint</i> - Face-to-face - Group meetings - Formal presentations	<i>Low Space Constraint</i> - Memos - Postal mail - Fax - Publications - Voice mail
<i>High Cost</i> - Group meetings - Formal presentations - Videoconference	<i>Low Cost</i> Bulletin boards

Exhibit 14-2:

Comparison of Communication Methods (cont.)

High Personal Warmth

- Face-to-face

Low Personal Warmth

- Memos
- Bulletin boards

High Formality

- Postal mail
- Publications

Low Formality

- Face-to-face
- Telephone
- Voice mail

High Scanability

- Memos
- Postal mail
- Fax
- Publications
- Bulletin boards

Low Scanability

- Formal presentations
- Face-to-face
- Telephone
- Group meetings
- Audio-videotapes
- Hotlines
- E-mail
- Computer conference
- Voice mail
- Teleconference
- Videoconference

Barriers to Communication

- **Filtering** – the deliberate manipulation of information to make it appear more favorable to the receiver.
- **Information overload** – occurs when information exceeds our processing capacity.
- **Language- Jargon** – specialized terminology or technical language that members of a group use to communicate among themselves.

Barriers to Communication

- **Emotions** – Extreme emotions hinder communication, ignore rationality – emotional judgements , defensive, verbally attack
- **Silence** – absence of information – no interest, feel powerless, unwillingness, negative emotions
- **National Culture** – high and low context cultures – Japan Vs US



Overcoming the Barriers

- **Use Feedback** – ask questions about a message to determine whether it was received and understood as intended.
- **Simplify Language** – consider the audience to whom the message is directed and tailor the language to them.
- **Active listening** – listening for full meaning without making premature judgments or interpretations.
- **Constrain Emotions** – get emotions under control before communicating
- **Watch non verbal cues** – Actions must align and reinforce words

Exhibit 14-3

Active Listening Behaviors





Formal Versus Informal Communication

- **Formal communication** – communication that takes place within prescribed organizational work arrangements.
- **Informal communication** – communication that is not defined by the organization's structural hierarchy.

Direction of Communication

- **Downward communication** – communication that flows downward from a manager to employees.
- **Upward communication** – communication that flows upward from employees to managers.
- **Lateral communication** – communication that takes place among any employees on the same organizational level.
- **Diagonal communication** – communication that cuts across work areas and organizational levels.

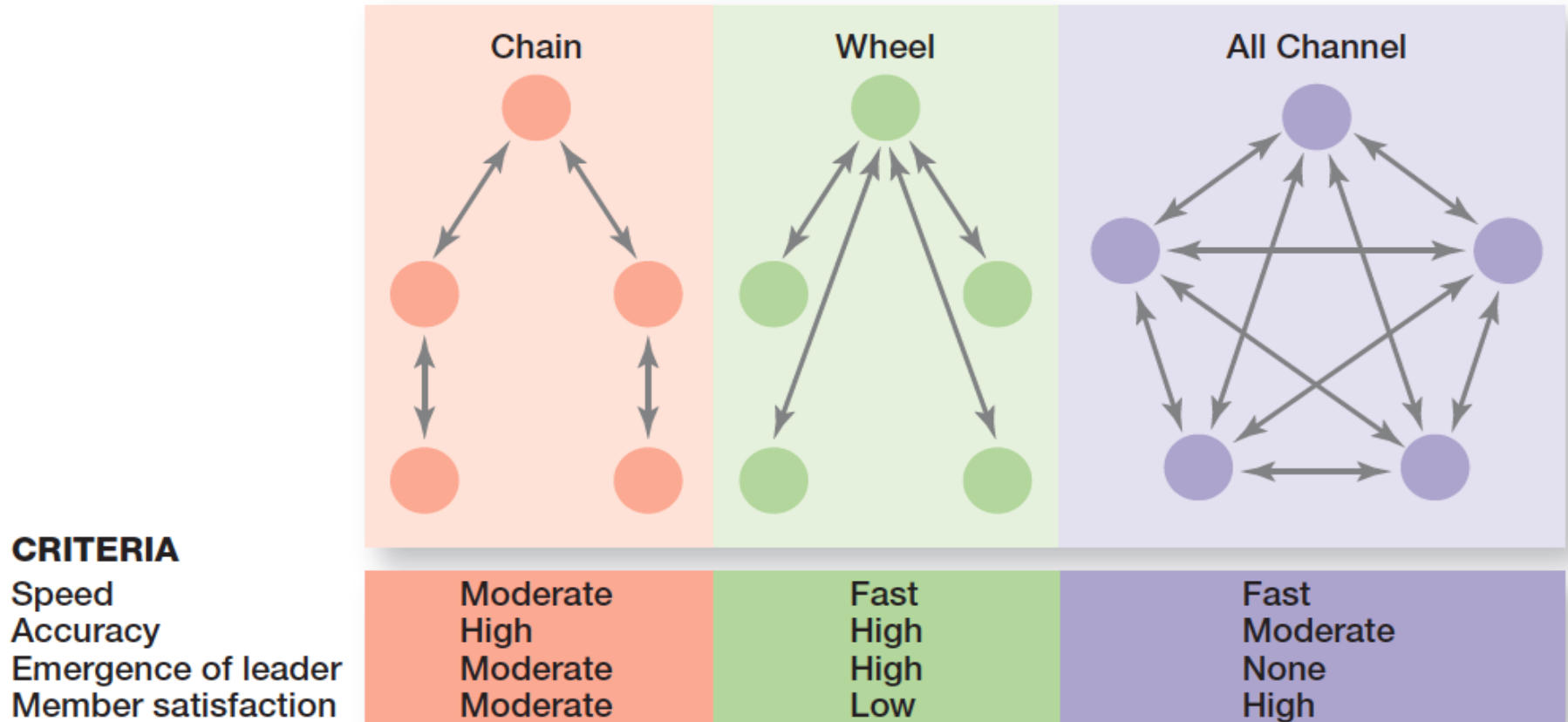


Organizational Communication Networks

- **Communication Networks** – the variety of patterns of vertical and horizontal flows of organizational communication – chain, wheel, all channel
- **Grapevine** – the informal organizational communication network.

Exhibit 14-4

Organizational Communication Networks



Communication Technology in the Workplace



- **24/7 Work, Social Media, and Cybersecurity** - IT has changed when and how employees communicate — always-on connectivity, new internal channels, and new security risks
- **Benefits**
 - Enables 24/7 connectivity and remote collaboration (monitoring and faster decision-making)
 - Internal social channels (e.g., HipChat) let teams share reports, comments, and best practices
 - Internal video portals support employee-driven content: demos, achievements, leadership messages

Communication Technology in the Workplace



- **Downsides**

- Social media can distract and reduce productivity (many employees use it at work)
 - Digital channels can lack personal interaction; not a full substitute for face-to-face for sensitive or emotional topics
- Speaker notes:

Cybersecurity Takeaways



- **Risks**
 - High-profile breaches show networks are vulnerable (examples: Sony, federal HR breach; many firms affected)
 - Data at risk: employee records, customer data, financials, intellectual property
- **Best practices** (keep communications secure)
 - Use strong, unique passwords and two-factor authentication
 - Be suspicious of external links/emails; train employees about phishing
 - Back up data, secure Wi-Fi, keep antivirus/antimalware/firewall updated
Speaker notes: Emphasize that while benefits are substantial, organizations must prioritize security measures and employee awareness to reduce breach risk



How to Become a Better Communicator

- Sharpen your persuasion skills
- Sharpen your speaking skills
- Sharpen your writing skills
- Sharpen your reading skills

Communicating Ethically

- **Ethical communication** – communication that includes all relevant information, is true in every sense, and is not deceptive in any way.